

THE IIPM Controversy

The IIPM controversy kick started when an article, written by then JAM writer Arjun Ravi, was published in JAM magazine, edited and published by Rashmi Bansal. The article was an in-depth look at the claims that IIPM (the Indian Institute of Planning and Management, an MBA school) made in its press advertisements. The piece did not raise much controversy when it was published (sometime in June-July 2004). Gaurav Sabnis, who published Vantage Point, posted about this article in his blog with a link to the article on the JAM Web site. This post on Sabnis' blog must have been read by some officials at IIPM. Sabnis, who at the time was working with IBM, was forced to quit his job after IIPM officials threatened to burn IBM laptops if Sabnis did not remove the post. The event caused an uproar in the Indian blogging community who rushed to the support of both Sabnis and Bansal, both of whom were facing much heat from IIPM students and officials. It is considered one of the turning points in Indian blogging.

2.1.3 Youth Curry

(<http://youthcurry.blogspot.com/>)

Rashmi Bansal is editor and publisher of JAM, a popular youth magazine. She writes articles for publications such as Mid-Day, Businessworld and Rediff.com. However, what has really got her the reputation as a writer to be noticed was through her blog, Youth Curry. Her blog has served as an opinion space for a knowledgeable view of trends among the Indian youth. It has also served her in sending out notices about her magazine and popularizing JAM. When the IIPM controversy occurred, her blog was at the receiving end of a horde of hate mail and comments from irate IIPM students and officials. But it was because of this medium that she was able to gain some major credibility amongst the Indian 'blogosphere', as it is so called. From the latest in films to B-school advice, Youth Curry serves up a sumptuous blog feast.